ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

Academic Reading · Mock Test 01

How to mark: 1 point per correct answer. Accept answers in capitals or lower case. Spelling must be correct. An answer shown as **x / y** means either x or y is accepted. Write the score in the box at the end.

Passage 1: The Bicycle: From Wooden Hobby-Horse to Everyday Machine

Question types: True/False/Not Given, Note Completion

Q	Answer	Where to find it / why
1	**FALSE**	Para 2 calls him ‘a German forester’, not an engineer.
2	**TRUE**	Para 2: bad harvests left oats scarce and horses expensive to feed.
3	**NOT GIVEN**	Para 2 says crowds gathered in Paris but never mentions Drais's earnings.
4	**TRUE**	Para 3: ‘iron-rimmed wheels earned them the nickname’.
5	**TRUE**	Para 4: one turn of the pedals = one turn of the wheel, so a bigger wheel covered more ground.
6	**FALSE**	Para 4: popular ‘mainly with young, athletic and wealthy men’.
7	**NOT GIVEN**	Para 5 says the Rover had a chain but does not say it was the first to do so.
8	**between**	Para 5: ‘The rider sat low, between the wheels’.
9	**air-filled**	Para 5: ‘an air-filled rubber tyre’.
10	**mass production**	Para 6: ‘Factories adopted mass production, prices fell’.
11	**independence**	Para 6: ‘the bicycle gave them independence’.
12	**fuel prices**	Para 7: ‘rising fuel prices and growing concern about pollution’.
13	**electric**	Para 7: ‘electric models are extending its appeal to older riders’.

Passage 2: Green Roofs: Gardens in the Sky

Question types: Matching Headings, Sentence Completion, Multiple Choice

Q	Answer	Where to find it / why
14	**ii**	Paragraph B: Cooling effect of plants; reduces the urban heat island.
15	**i**	Paragraph C: Roofs act like sponges and release water slowly.
16	**vii**	Paragraph D: Bees, butterflies and birds find habitats on roofs.
17	**iv**	Paragraph E: Heavier structure, higher initial price and maintenance.
18	**vi**	Paragraph F: Longer membrane life, lower energy use, higher rents.
19	**v**	Paragraph G: Rooftop farms and public parks.
20	**growing material**	Para A: ‘waterproofing, drainage and growing material’.
21	**overflows**	Para C: ‘overflows of untreated waste into rivers’.
22	**islands**	Para D: ‘roof habitats are isolated islands’.
23	**structural reinforcement**	Para E: ‘expensive structural reinforcement’.

Q	Answer	Where to find it / why
24	**B**	Para E: owners ‘rarely see the financial reward… such gains are shared by the whole city’.
25	**B**	Para F: Toronto ‘now requires green roofs on large new buildings’.
26	**C**	Para G: ‘cities need not choose between building and nature if they… build upwards’.

Passage 3: The Myth of Multitasking

Question types: Yes/No/Not Given, Multiple Choice, Summary Completion (word list)

Q	Answer	Where to find it / why
27	**YES**	Para 1: job advertisements ‘routinely demand it’.
28	**NO**	Para 2: the tiny delays ‘accumulate’ over a working day.
29	**NOT GIVEN**	Para 3 does not compare managers with other staff.
30	**YES**	Para 4: ‘even hands-free phone calls can impair driving’.
31	**NO**	Para 5: ‘This does not prove that multitasking damages the brain’.
32	**YES**	Para 6: ‘Even there… training staff to prioritise… produces better results’.
33	**C**	Para 2: people ‘become slower and make more errors immediately after each switch’.
34	**A**	Para 4: one task is ‘so well practised that it requires almost no conscious thought’.
35	**D**	Para 5: not proof of damage, yet it ‘challenges the comforting idea that practice makes perfect’.
36	**B**	Para 6: ‘Such policies are not a cure, since some jobs genuinely involve unpredictable demands’.
37	**A (predator)**	Para 7: ‘notice a predator while they were gathering food’.
38	**C (triggers)**	Para 7: ‘endless triggers for that instinct’.
39	**D (skill)**	Para 7: ‘mistaken the reflex for a skill’.
40	**E (unproductive)**	Para 7: ‘may feel unproductive at first’.

Passage 1 ___ /13	**Passage 2** ___ /13	**Passage 3** ___ /14	**TOTAL** ___ /40 → Band ____

Academic Reading raw score → band (approximate; the official table varies slightly between test versions)

Raw score	Band
39–40	9
37–38	8.5
35–36	8
33–34	7.5
30–32	7
27–29	6.5
23–26	6
19–22	5.5
15–18	5
13–14	4.5
10–12	4
8–9	3.5
6–7	3